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**EGE 312 | Slogan Activity**

## Dig deep enough and you'll bury us all.

There is something almost poetic about the way mining works — you break the earth open looking for something valuable, and in doing so, you leave behind something broken. The slogan "Dig deep enough and you'll bury us all" is about exactly that. It seems like a straightforward observation on the surface: the deeper you mine, the more unstable the ground above it becomes. Sinkholes, landslides, collapsed tunnels — these are not hypothetical consequences, they are documented ones. The literal image is of a hole that eventually becomes a grave, not just for the mountain, but for the communities built around it.

But the slogan carries more weight than its literal reading. The "we" in "bury us all" is doing a lot of work. It is not just the miners underground, or the farmers downstream watching their irrigation turn gray, or the Indigenous communities whose ancestral lands get carved up without meaningful consent — it is all of us. Mining operates on a logic of extraction: take what is valuable, leave what is not, and move on. The problem is that what gets left behind — the contaminated rivers, the eroded hillsides, the displaced communities — does not stay behind. It works its way into water tables, into food systems, into the quiet economic desperation of towns that were promised development and got a pit instead. The deeper the industry digs, the more it buries the future it claims to be building.

I chose mining because it is not an abstract issue from somewhere far away. Mindanao, the island where I live and study, sits on some of the richest mineral deposits in the country — and also some of the most vulnerable ecosystems and most marginalized communities. The rivers here carry stories, and lately some of them carry sediment they were never supposed to carry. I am not anti-progress, and I think that is an important thing to say. But progress that comes at the cost of the people and the land it was supposed to benefit in the first place is not progress — it is just a slower kind of loss. That is what this slogan is about, and that is why it matters.

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